

dures were not followed, which resulted in this error," Pachauri says.

Pachauri, who wears two hats as the director-general of TERI and the world's top climate official, is now, quite literally, facing the heat in a two-front war. A British newspaper has raised questions about a possible conflict of interest, pointing out that Pachauri is a director or adviser to a score of companies which form an "international climate industry". It raised questions as to how the world's top climate official—Pachauri lives in Golf Links, one of the most expensive pieces of real estate in India

and allegedly wears \$1000 suits—could head bodies that stood to benefit from IPCC recommendations. It stated that TERI makes money from the policies Pachauri formulates and continues to have close links with the Tata Group, which has helped it in its carbon trading business.

The IPCC chairman has denied all these allegations, stating TERI is a non-profit institute; that it is not owned by any private entity, is a registered society and open to government scrutiny as a recognised scientific and industrial research organisation. He says the money he earns from various

commitments goes into his organisation and not in his pocket. "TERI works under all the laws and regulations of the country and has continuously been provided coverage by the Income Tax authorities," he said.

Pachauri points out that the charges levelled by the British newspaper are similar to what known climate sceptic Lord Monckton had waved at the Copenhagen summit without much success. Pachauri and others who back him look upon the torrent of charges and the attack of the IPCC report as motivated by powerful western lobbies who are against cleaning their act and changing their lifestyles to reduce carbon emission which they had promised to do under the 1997 Kyoto Protocol. Industrialised nations, who are the major polluters and had contributed to the alarming rise of carbon dioxide in the atmosphere, were to reduce their emissions to an average 5 per cent below 1990 levels. But most failed to do so, with the US even boycotting the protocol. The failure of Copenhagen is a direct result of the foot-dragging by these countries who still refuse to carry out their legal obligations.

Yet, Pachauri has a lot to answer for the bloomers in the IPCC report which has resulted in its overall credibility being questioned. He says the Himalayan glaciers goof-up was just one mistake in over 3,000 pages of the report. "Please, don't throw the baby out with the bathwater. The Working Group II report is a 938-page document in which this error has occurred. There is a huge volume of other scientific information in the report which is valid and should not get diminished," he said in a written response.

Embarrassingly, Pachauri's own colleagues at TERI have discovered several other snafus in the section with the 2035 date. The report says the Himalayan glaciers are 5,00,000 sq km while they actually cover only 33,050 sq km. In the same section, the rate of retreat of the Pindari glacier is given as 135.2 m each year. A calculation on the basis of the data inserted establishes it as 23.47 m, says Hasnain who, ironically, now works with TERI.

CHARGES AGAINST PACHAURI

- IPCC's unscientific conclusion that Himalayan glaciers will melt by 2035 has dented its credibility
- He has business interests in bodies which have invested billions of dollars in organisations dependent on the IPCC's policy recommendations
- He has profited from the international climate industry, making millions from various organisations like Credit Suisse and Toyota where he works as an adviser

HIS RESPONSE

- Admits that the IPCC made an error in the glacier study but defends its overall climate change assessment
- The IPCC does not make policy recommendations. All its reports are in the public domain and do not contain anything that could have any proprietary benefit
- Denies charges. Says he works only towards the development of renewable energy projects in these organisations. Payments received are made to TERI and not to him as an individual.

"I have no intentions of resigning. I was elected by acclamation and have a task to complete."

R.K. PACHAURI
CHAIRMAN, IPCC